CHRISTIAN KONTZ

Stanford University ◇ Graduate School of Business
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EDUCATION

Stanford Graduate School of Business *2020–present*
Ph.D. Candidate in Finance
Dissertation Committee: Juliane Begenau, Hanno Lustig (co-chair), Monika Piazzesi, Amit Seru (co-chair)

Barcelona Graduate School of Economics, Universitat Pompeu Fabra *2018*
Master in International Trade, Finance, and Development

University of Hamburg *2017*
B.Sc. in Economics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Climate Finance, Empirical Asset Pricing

WORKING PAPERS

1. *The Real Cost of Benchmarking* with Sebastian Hanson [SSRN]
   - Winner of FIRS 2025 Conference Prize for PhD Students and SFS Cavalcade NA 2025 PhD Student Award
2. *Do ESG Investors Care About Carbon Emissions? Evidence From Securitized Auto Loans* [SSRN]
   - Winner of PRI Best PhD Student Paper in 2025, GRASFI Conference 2024 Best PhD Paper Award, FIRS 2024 Conference Prize for PhD Students, 2024 Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. *The Cross-section of Prices* with Hanno Lustig and Miguel Chumbo
2. *From Markets to Meters: How Passive Investing Affects Utility Rates*
3. *ESG Induced Capital Misallocation: is ESG Doing Good, by Doing Well?*

PRESENTATIONS

AFA Annual Meeting* *2026*

SFS Cavalcade NA Conference, FIRS Conference, Four Corners/FMRC Conference on Indexing, *2025*
Carey Finance Conference*, Investment Company Institute, Northeastern University Finance Conference,
UIC Finance Conference[c], AFA Annual Meeting (2x Poster), Inter-Finance PhD Seminar

FIRS Conference, SoFiE Conference, SITE New Research in Asset Pricing[†], GRASFI Conference, *2024*
OU-RFS Climate and Energy Conference, CEPR-ESSEC-Luxembourg Conference on Sustainable
Financial Intermediation, FMA Conference, MFR Summer Session for Young Scholars (Poster),
UC Santa Cruz CAFIN, German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (CESifo),
Citadel[c], Inter-Finance PhD Seminar

Harvard Climate Economics Workshop, USC Marshall PhD Conference, MFR/IMSI Conference (Poster), *2023*
UChicago Workshop on Climate, Uncertainty, and Policy, NYU Shanghai/SoFiE Summer School

German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (DIW) *2022*

*scheduled, [c]co-author, [†]declined/scheduling conflict

OTHER RESEARCH POSITIONS

The Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE Frankfurt *April 2025*
Visiting Researcher

University of Chicago *Spring 2023*
Visiting Student, invited by Fernando Alvarez, Lars Hansen, and Esteban Rossi-Hansberg

US Census Bureau *2022-present*
Special Sworn Status (SSS)

Princeton University *2018–2020*
Research Assistant to Natalie Cox, Moritz Lenel, and Adrien Matray

University of Hamburg *2016–2017*
Research Assistant to Christiane Hellmanzik and Mu-Chun Wang

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Stanford Graduate School of Business

Capital Markets and Institutional Investing, TA to Hanno Lustig and Ana Marshall	*2023, 2024*
Corporations, Finance, and Governance in the Global Economy, TA to Amit Seru	*2022, 2023, 2024, 2025*
Debt Markets, TA to Darrell Duffie	*2021, 2022*
Modeling for Investment Management, TA to Steven Grenadier	*2023, 2024, 2025*

University of Hamburg

Macroeconomics 1 (UG), TA to Kristin Paetz	*2016*

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students	*2025*
SFS Cavalcade PhD Student Award	*2025*
Stanford GSB Academic Career Advancement Fellowship	*2025-2026*
Nominated for the Gerald J. Lieberman Fellowship by Stanford GSB Finance Faculty	*2025*
Finalist 5th Annual Sustainable Finance in Fixed Income Research Competition (FIASI)	*2025*
American Finance Association Travel Grant (AFA Annual Meeting)	*2025*
FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students	*2024*
Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize	*2024*
GRASFI Conference Best PhD Paper Award	*2024*
Graduate Fellowship, Stanford Graduate School of Business	*2020–2025*
Pre-doctoral Fellowship, Julis-Rabinowitz Center at Princeton University	*2018–2020*
Graduate Fellowship, Friedrich-Naumann-Foundation for Freedom	*2017–2018*
Undergraduate Fellowship, Friedrich-Naumann-Foundation for Freedom	*2015–2017*

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Lecture Series Organization: Stanford Lecture Series on the History of Economic Thought (2020/21)
Seminar Series Organization: Inter-Finance PhD Seminar (2024/25), GSB Finance Brown Bag (2022/23)
Referee: Journal of Finance, Management Science

BUSINESS EXPERIENCE

Co-founder and CFO, vierfreunde GmbH (*Kerbholz - wooden fashion accessories*)	*2011–2014*
Apprenticeship as Industriekaufmann (industrial business management assistant)	*2009–2011*